

IRONROOT Systems and Gameplay Blueprint

Combat Aspects, Harmonic Substrate, Name-Shear, roguelike loops, and major erasures.

Purpose: define the playable systems that make IRONROOT feel deterministic, learnable, hard to enter, and deeply speedrunnable once understood.

1. Main Loop

```
Explore 3D Veyrholt
-> Encounter enemy, faction, siren, or Shadow
-> Camera locks a combat interpretation
-> Player chooses or is forced into an Aspect
-> Combat resolves through resonance, position, dissonance, and identity state
-> Event writes to the Ironroot
-> Next cycle inherits the record
```

2. Combat Aspects

Aspect	Game Mode	System Function	Narrative Meaning
Ledger	Turn-based / tactical	Initiative, debt, proof, witnesses, status rules	Fight inside Veyrholt's law.
Knife	2D action	Spacing, parry, cancels, hit-stop, execution	Fight as the former Root-Pruner.
Root	Dimensional hybrid	Camera plane, Spirit overlap, voxel-slice truth	Fight through body-map-soul correspondence.
Vowless	Refusal state	No conversion, restraint, sheathing, silence	Refuse to let grief become a system.

3. Harmonic Substrate

The Harmonic Substrate is the deterministic physics-memory layer. Every relevant entity can carry resonance, alchemical tier, material behavior, identity state, and positional authority.

Tier	Frequency	Physical Behavior	Use
Nigredo	40Hz	Mass, gravity wells, crushing hit-stop	Taurus, debt-stone, body contracts
Albedo	432Hz	Stable collision, clean radial repel	Cancer/Pisces, cleansing, water memory
Citrinitas	Inverse Hz	Suction, negative velocity, phase inversion	Gemini, breath, testimony, witness vents
Rubedo	800Hz+	Multi-hit plasma shockwaves, excitation	Aries/Leo, fire, violence, exaltation

4. Space Logic

The world remains 3D, but combat can collapse into a 2D or tactical interpretation through the camera. Because 1 pixel is effectively 1 voxel, the camera is not cosmetic. It is a dimensional selector.

```
3D voxel world
-> camera selects XY, XZ, or YZ plane
-> terrain projects into combat space
-> depth becomes layer, hazard, or Spirit overlap
-> combat resolves deterministically
```

5. Dissonance: Quincunx

Quincunx is the game grammar for incompatible systems forced into one encounter. It creates low-grade systemic irritation because the player's tools and the victory condition do not speak the same language.

Example	Demand A	Demand B	Result
Aries/Virgo	Fast melee aggression	Slow proof/inventory precision	Speed becomes liability.
Gemini/Capricorn	Constant evasive movement	Stationary resource channel	Movement prevents progress; stillness invites danger.
Knife/Ledger Boss	Parry and punish	Protect a fragile name-record	Damage race conflicts with moral objective.

6. Boss Architecture: Yod

A Yod boss uses two cooperating pressures against a player apex. The two base systems cooperate with each other, but both are alien to the player's current solution pattern.

Yod Boss = Apex Identity + Base Pressure A + Base Pressure B
 Base A and B cooperate.
 The player cannot solve both with one habit.

7. Positional Overcoming

Elemental counters are not flat. Position, initiative, elevation, and camera authority can override natural counters. Element says what should happen. Position says who gets to enforce it.

Authority Source	Effect
Higher elevation	Attacker gains bonification or suppresses natural counter.
Initiative advantage	Earlier actor imposes rule before defender's element resolves.
Camera-superior angle	Plane logic lets an otherwise weak attack dominate.
Shadow route knowledge	Shadow may punish habitual paths even from weaker resonance.

8. Major Erasures

Major erasures are deterministic world boss events: a church cleanse, village wipe, memory audit, bridge purge, bloodline cut, or correspondence break. They are foreshadowed, audible, traceable, interruptible, preventable, persistent if failed, and speedunnable if mastered.

Phase	Player Access
Hidden Priming	Experts notice early signals.
Local Rumor	NPCs hint, not explain.
Environmental Warning	Bells, chains, water, graves, animals change.
Name-Shear Prelude	Sound gives directional urgency.
Active Cleanse	Boss/ritual/faction event can be interrupted.
Aftermath	World state changes if failed.

9. Root-Cycle Roguelike

A Root-Cycle is one expedition into the city. It ends by return, death, or erasure. Return banks records. Death opens Spirit routes and strengthens Shadows. Erasure scars the world.

Roguelike thesis: Every run is a cut, every death is a route, every siren is a lost name, every Shadow is a remembered habit, and every reset is the city proving that nothing was reset.